

Raisa Sherif

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Academic Appointment

Senior Research Fellow, **since 2021**
Department of Public Economics
Max Planck Institute for Tax Law and Public Finance, Munich, Germany

Affiliations

CESifo Affiliate, **since 2026**
Research Affiliate, IZA (Institute for the Study of Labor), **since 2026**
Invited Researcher, J-PAL, **since 2024**
Affiliate, GAP (Global Action for Policy) Initiative, Northeastern University, **since 2023**

Education

Ph.D. Economics, **2021**
Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität Munich

Integrated Masters in Economics, **2009-2014**
Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras)

Research

[Shaping Minds: The Transformative Effects of Theatre-Based Learning](#), with Ritam Chaurey, Sara Constantino, Shantanu Khanna, Abhiroop Mukhopadhyay, Nishith Prakash
Journal of Development Economics, (*Conditionally accepted*)

[Do perceptions match pollution levels? Evidence from three Indian cities](#), with Matt Goldberg, Shariq Mohammed
Nature Communications Sustainability (*Conditionally Accepted*)

[Impact, Inspiration, or Image: On the Trade-Offs in Pro-Environmental Behaviors](#), with Sven Simon
Journal of Environmental Economics and Management, Volume 134, November 2025, 103214

[Personal Initiative Skills, Gender Gaps, and Social Norms: Experimental Evidence from Rural India](#), with Sofia Amaral, Isis Gaddis, Shirleen Manzur, Alreena Pinto, Jayati Sethi
- **World Bank Blogs** [Soft skills training helps grow businesses in rural India](#)

[Intergenerational Transmission of Pro-Environmental Attitudes and Behaviors](#), CESifo Working Paper No. 12499, with Shubhro Bhattacharya, Sara Constantino, Nirajana Mishra, Nishith Prakash, Shwetlena Sabarwal and Dighbijoy Samaddar (*Submitted*)
- Featured in the **World Bank report** [Choosing Our Future: Education for Climate Action](#)

[Sorting it Out: Intention-Action Gap in Waste Segregation in Urban India](#), IZA Discussion Paper No. 17508, with Ahana Basistha, Nishith Prakash (*Revise & Resubmit, Environment and Resource Economics*)

[Are pro-environment behaviours substitutes or complements? Evidence from the field](#), Working Paper of the Max Planck Institute for Tax Law and Public Finance No. 2021-03 (*Submitted*)

[Why do we vote? Evidence on expressive voting](#), Working Paper of the Max Planck Institute for Tax Law and Public Finance, with Afq bin Oslan (*Submitted*)

Works in progress

Evaluation of Arts-Integrated Social-Emotional Learning in Indian Government Schools, with Ashutosh Bhuradia and Shantanu Khanna

[Socio-Emotional Skills and Climate Education: A Randomized Evaluation of Air Quality Curriculum in Indian Schools](#), with Ashutosh Bhuradia

[Information Campaigns, Environment Norms, and Behaviour: Evidence from the Field](#), with Esther Blanco

Ignoring Environmental Impact: Strategic Ignorance to be Seen as Green, with Paul Meißner and Sven Simon

Seasonal Discounting and Underinvestment in Air Pollution Protection Measures: Field Experiment in Delhi, with Ahana Basistha and Andreas Ponderfer

Grants & Awards

Total funding: USD 854,084

2026 JPAL Learning for All Initiative **USD 94,479**, Max Planck Society **EUR 30,000**

2025 Max Planck Society **EUR 70,000**

2025 Diligentia Grant, “Seasonal Discounting and Underinvestment in Air Pollution Protection Measures: Field Experiment in Delhi” (Co-PI) **EUR 50,000**

2023 World Bank, “Personal Initiative Skills, Gender Gaps, and Social Norms: Experimental Evidence from Rural India” (Co-PI) **USD 350,000**

2023 J-PAL Learning for All Initiative, “Shaping Minds: The Transformative Effects of Theater-Based Learning” (Co-PI) **USD 104,605**

2023 World Bank, “Intergenerational Transmission of Pro-Environmental Attitudes and Behaviors” (Co-PI) **USD 85,000**

2023 Max Planck Society **EUR 20,000**

2022 Max Planck Society **EUR 30,000**

2022 Invitee to the 7th Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting in Economic Sciences

2013 German Academic Exchange Service - WISE Award

2011-13 Institute Merit Prize * 2, IIT Madras

2013 *S. Viswanathan Prize* and *Swati-Jayalakshmi Memorial Award* for academic excellence, IIT Madras

Professional Experience

Venture Village (Finland/India)

Advisor on school partnerships and curriculum innovation in environmental education

2021–present

Lindau Mentor Hub

Co-founder

Developed a global mentoring platform linking 200+ scientists and early-career researchers

Funded by the Lindau Nobel Laureate Meetings and Dieter Schwartz Foundation

2021–present

Green Kerala Mission, Government of Kerala, Research Consultant, India

2018–2020

Barclays Bank, Interest Rates Derivatives Division, Business Analyst

2014–2015

Service

Equal Opportunities Officer, Max Planck Institute for Tax Law and Public Finance

2020–present

Refereeing Experimental Economics, Economics of Education Review, American Political Science Review, Nature Scientific Reports, Journal of Environmental Economics and Management

Conference Organisator Workshop on Pro-Environmental Behaviours: Drivers and Consequences

March, 2025

Media & outreach – contributor to newspapers: *Financial Express* and *Malayala Manorama* (Malayalam language Daily); co-host of the Max Planck Economics Podcast

Teaching & Student Supervision

Behavioural Environmental Economics, Bachelor Course, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität Munich
Developed and taught the course, Summer Semester 2024, Winter Semester 2023-24
Rating: 4.8/5

International Public Economics, TA - Graduate class, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität Munich
Winter Semester 2017, Rating: 4.8/5

Supervision of Bachelor & Master Thesis Marie Cramer (2025), Daniel Froeschl (2025), Christian Haider (2025), Khang Nguyen (2025), Maximilian Marrero (2024)

Conferences & Seminar Presentations

2026: Advances in Field Experiments (scheduled), 7th World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists, University of Konstanz (Invited talk), Strange Political Bedfellows Workshop Berlin (Invited talk)

2025: European University Institute (Invited talk); The World Bank - Economics of Education Seminar (Invited talk); University of Innsbruck (Invited talk); Behavioral Research in Economics Workshop India; 20th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, Indian Statistical Institute, Delhi

2024: Stanford University (Invited talk); European Economic Association Annual Meeting; Mannheim Conference on Energy and the Environment; Experimental Economics for the Environment; Household Economics in Developing Countries Workshop; NEUDC; KDI School-World Bank DIME 5th Development Impact Conference

2023: European Economic Association Annual Meeting; International Meeting on Experimental and Behavioural Social Sciences (IMEBESS); Northeastern University (Invited talk); Symposium on Economic Experiments in Developing Countries

2022: Experimental Sciences Association World Meeting, Boston; Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting in Economics (Invited talk); 17th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, Delhi

2021: German Economic Association Virtual Annual Meeting; Experimental Sciences Association Global Online Meetings; Center for Rationality and Competition Summer School: Science-Based Policy Advice; 9th Mannheim Conference on Energy and the Environment

2020: Micro Workshop, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität Munich; Behavioral Research in Economics Workshop, India

2018: ESA World Meeting, Berlin; IIPF Annual Congress, Tampere; Public Economic Theory Conference, Hanoi; International Meeting on Experimental and Behavioral Social Sciences (IMEBESS), Florence; European Public Choice Society Conference, Rome; Micro Workshop, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität Munich

2017: Workshop on Public Finance and Political Economy V, Berlin; Development Economics Workshop, Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität Munich; Summer School in Experimental Economics, Tinbergen Institute, Amsterdam

Languages

Programming STATA, R, Python, zTree, OTree, Qualtrics

Human English (fluent), Malayalam (native), German (B2), Hindi (intermediate), Tamil (intermediate)